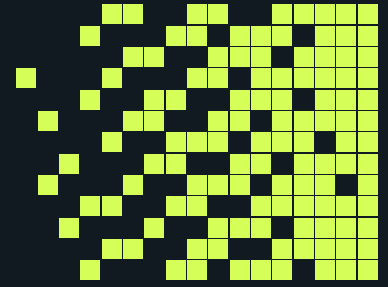


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Routes. Training. Pilot. Economics. Goals.

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WHARF MARKET + PRICE CEILING EDITION / SEPTEMBER 15, 2026



02

Start small. Prove the experience.

Executive recommendation and reading guide

RECOMMENDED LAUNCH

Lead with Branch B: one owner-guide, two departures per week for six paid weeks, four paying guests minimum and eight maximum. Test a proposed \$149 pilot ticket and aim for 60-72 paid guests.

Allow approximately one to two weeks for rehearsals and operational setup; permits and insurance can extend this. Budget about **\$3,000 in starting cash**, subject to quotes, plus personal living-expense runway. Keep owner time visible at **\$40/hour**.

Current status: the website describes \$195 A/B tickets and a \$40 optional guided return. Sales remain disabled and the review site requires the owner account. The \$149 pilot, four-person minimum and proposed policies in this plan have not been activated. Branch C remains a separate proposal.

Read this section	Pages
Offer, market and routes A/B/C	3-7
Fog planning, Muni teaching and guide operations	8-11
Customers, six-week pilot and success benchmarks	12-14
Startup cash, delivery costs, profit and cost reduction	15-18
Full-schedule ROI, downside cases and optional products	19-21
Permissions, checkout, launch roadmap and branding	22-24
Assumptions register and validation deadlines	25-35
Goals, milestones and weekly decision log	36-39
Pricing reassessment, sensitivity and price-test gates	40-43
Wharf market, price ceilings and private-tour economics	44-50
Clickable sources and model notes	51-53

How this edition resolves earlier drafts: use the six-week Branch B pilot and 4.5 departure hours for initial launch planning. The earlier 52-departure monthly model is retained as a separate scale scenario using its original labor assumptions. Neither is measured performance. September 15 replaces the earlier \$100 pilot recommendation with \$149. Pages 40-43 explain the pilot decision; pages 44-50 add the Wharf market review and \$225 upper test. \$195 remains the website price; sales stay closed.



03

The offer and the real visitor spend

Proposed pilot and current website offer are different decisions

Product	Price	Scope / status
Branch A	\$195 current	8:30 AM-12 PM. North Beach, Chinatown, SoMa and Ferry Building.
Branch B	\$195 current	2-5:30 PM. Dogpatch, builders, sports and the waterfront.
Branch B paid pilot	\$149 proposed	Six weeks; Sat/Sun afternoons; 4-8 guests. Not activated.
Guided Wharf return	+\$40 optional	A/B; approximately 45 extra guide minutes. Guest fare is separate.
Branch C	Not selected	\$195 appears only as an exploratory financial assumption on page 21. Separate sunny-day outing.
Muni day pass	\$5.70 when needed	Guest purchase. Regular buses, streetcars and light rail; not cable cars.

Included and paid separately

Included: a human guide, neighborhood interpretation, questions and practical Muni instruction. Guest purchases: transit, RH or Outerlands coffee, meals, tea, shopping, garden admission, game tickets and optional gratuities. Company stops are exterior stories; office, stadium and Alcatraz admission are not included.

Visitor subtotal: proposed \$149 pilot + \$5.70 pass = **\$154.70**; with the optional \$40 escort, **\$194.70**. Current \$195 offer + pass = **\$200.70**, or **\$240.70** with escort. Coffee and other purchases are extra. Existing fares or youth eligibility can change transit cost; regular Muni is free for ages 18 and under.

A/B brand schedule: Tuesday-Sunday, no Mondays. Initial pilot concentrates B on two days. Guests must be older than 15 (16+); finalize arrangements for under-18 guests. Capacity remains eight. Publish verified walking distances, access constraints, meeting point and endpoint before selling.

Sources: [01] SFMTA: fares and day pass



04

Earn the price through useful local knowledge

Food, bike and Santa Fe prices rechecked September 15; earlier context labeled below

Experience	Advertised price / duration	What is included
SF City Guides [18]	Free; optional \$20 / 1.5-2 h	Earlier Sep 14 context; nonprofit model.
Alcatraz [19]	\$47.95 day; \$59.65 night; \$104.65 behind scenes	Earlier Sep 14 context; ferry/audio, different format.
Local Tastes [20]	\$89.04 / 3 h; \$99.64 / 4 h	Food/drinks; includes published 6% online fee.
Dandyhorse [22]	From \$99 / about 3-3.5 h	E-bike, equipment and pastry; max eight.
Bay City Bike [23]	\$115 / 3-4 h	E-bike, equipment, guide and bonus rental.
Edible Excursions [24]	\$137 / 3 h	North Berkeley walk with tastings.
Heritage / Santa Fe [26]	\$195 + tax / 3.5 h	E-bike and gear; max six; return to start.
AI SF Tour	\$149 pilot proposal / 3.5 h	\$195 website price; human guide, Muni teaching; fares/coffee extra.

These are advertised prices, not completed checkout quotes. Availability, remaining taxes/fees and final inclusions were not tested. No numerical market average is inferred. No completed price-matched AI-specialist tour comparison was established in this search.

Santa Fe reference: Heritage Inspirations lists \$195 + tax for 3.5 hours with an e-bike, equipment, a six-guest maximum and return to the start. Adopt its careful curation and personal attention; the SF offer has different inclusions and needs its own price test. \$195 is already premium; the updated \$149 pilot has its own cost and demand rationale on pages 40-43. [26]

THE VALUE TO PROVE

A curious visitor leaves with an understanding of contemporary SF, memorable human stories, and the confidence to navigate Muni independently. Premium pricing depends on guide quality and useful interpretation, not the stop count.



05

Branch A | Old soul. New intelligence.

8:30 AM-12 PM / 210 minutes / Wharf to Ferry Building area

Time	Route and guide action
8:30-8:40	Wharf welcome, headcount, fare check and an Alcatraz view story when visible.
8:40-9:05	Walk toward North Beach via Taylor/Columbus and Washington Square.
9:05-9:20	Italian community, gathering places and the exchange of ideas.
9:20-9:55	Walk into Chinatown; community, civic voice and Chinatown-Rose Pak Station.
9:55-10:20	T Third southbound to Yerba Buena/Moscone; include entry, wait, ride and exit.
10:20-10:30	Moscone: Steve Jobs, the 2007 iPhone introduction and changing interfaces.
10:30-11:10	Walk toward the Howard Street AI corridor and interpret Anthropic from public space. Reconfirm company frontage before each date.
11:10-11:25	Prechecked restroom/comfort break. Refreshments are guest purchases.
11:25-11:45	Walk to Ferry Building; connect older city networks with newer ones.
11:45-12:00	Buffer, questions and an onward journey chosen by the guest.

Rehearsal allowances: approximately 80 minutes walking, 25 transit, 75 interpretation, 15 break and 15 buffer. These are planning timings, not measured group results. Verify exact standing areas, walking distance, restrooms and accessible alternatives.

Delay recovery: shorten optional interpretation; never rush crossings. The optional guided return can use the F toward the Wharf from the Ferry Building, with walking at either end. Allow about 25-40 minutes subject to service. South Bay houses and campuses remain stories, not stops.

Sources: [04] SFMTA: T Third Street | [06] SFMTA: F Market & Wharves | [39] Apple: January 2007 iPhone introduction



06

Branch B | Builders. Ballers. & the Bay.

2-5:30 PM / 210 minutes / Wharf to Oracle Park area

Time	Route and guide action
2:00-2:05	Wharf welcome; fare preparation should already be covered in the arrival message.
2:05-3:05	Proposed Muni connection: 30 inbound from Columbus/Bay to Stockton/Washington, then T Third southbound toward Third/20th. Include all walks, waits and teaching.
3:05-3:15	Walk to RH San Francisco, 590 20th Street.
3:15-3:35	RH / The Palm Court: guest-paid coffee and industrial-history context. Preconfirm quick coffee-only service and group access.
3:35-3:50	Pier 70 / Y Combinator neighborhood: making, funding and testing ideas from public streets.
3:50-4:15	Walk to Chase Center; Warriors, Valkyries and waterfront change.
4:15-4:40	OpenAI neighborhood/exterior interpretation; everyday AI and computing. Recheck frontage and permission boundaries.
4:40-5:05	Walk toward Oracle Park, avoiding event barriers and crowd pinch points.
5:05-5:15	Giants and the Bay; show the real date-specific official schedule.
5:15-5:30	Delay buffer, questions, onward trip teaching and close.

Rehearse the full route before committing to every stop. If more than 15 minutes behind, reduce optional Pier 70 wandering or interpretation rather than rush. RH seating, rooftop access, office access and a full meal are not promised. Arrange a replacement break if quick service is unavailable.

The optional return uses an appropriate current 30 outbound stop near the ballpark area; allow approximately 40-55 minutes, subject to events and service. Guests staying for a game are not promised a later escort without a separate arrangement.

Sources: [04] SFMTA: T Third Street | [05] SFMTA: 30 Stockton | [13] RH: San Francisco restaurant | [15] Giants: official game schedule | [16] Warriors: official game schedule | [17] Valkyries: official game schedule | [38] Y Combinator: San Francisco campus



07

Branch C | When the fog takes a day off.

Separate proposed sunny-weekend outing / 11 AM-3:30 PM

WEST SIDE ONLY WHEN THE BEACH IS CLEAR

Ocean Beach, Outerlands, the Japanese Tea Garden, Haight-Ashbury and Japantown are outside A/B. A sunny downtown forecast is not enough. This outing needs its own route trial, price and weather policy.

Time	Proposed route
11:00-11:30	Ocean Beach near Judah/La Playa: shore-based surf-culture story and walk toward Outerlands.
11:30-11:50	Outerlands, 4001 Judah: guest-paid coffee, with takeaway or another confirmed quick-service arrangement.
11:50-12:35	N Judah inbound from the 46th Avenue area toward 9th Avenue, then walk into Golden Gate Park.
12:35-1:10	Japanese Tea Garden: entry, brief visit and restroom. Admission and optional tea are extra.
1:10-1:50	Walk through the park toward Haight-Ashbury on a rehearsed route.
1:50-2:10	Haight-Ashbury: counterculture and creative communities.
2:10-3:00	Proposed 7/22 connection via Fillmore toward Geary, including wait and walking time.
3:00-3:30	Japantown orientation, questions and close; optional purchases afterward.

Outerlands lists weekend brunch 9:30 AM-2 PM, walk-in only, with a maximum seated party of eight. Eight guests plus one guide exceed that limit. Confirm takeaway or another acceptable arrangement; do not assume seating. Coffee is paid by the tourist. [14]

The 270-minute route is unvalidated. Garden/group permissions and any NPS authorization must be confirmed. No Wharf return is included. A second guide is needed if C overlaps A/B; otherwise remove conflicting departures and revenue. South Bay locations remain stories.

Sources: [07] SFMTA: N Judah | [08] SFMTA: 7 Haight-Noriega / connections | [09] SFMTA: 22 Fillmore | [11] NPS: guided-service authorizations and fees | [12] Gardens of Golden Gate Park: tickets | [14] Outerlands: address, hours and group policy



08

Fog: choose the season, check the beach.

Qualitative planning guidance, not monthly probabilities

HIGHEST FOG SENSITIVITY: LATE SPRING AND SUMMER

Plan cautiously for May-August, particularly the summer months. NPS identifies September and October as Ocean Beach's sunniest months. Conditions still need checking on the day. [10]

Season	Planning interpretation	Branch C decision
January-March	Winter rain and variable coastal conditions	Only selected clear, comfortable days.
April	Transition toward the coastal fog season	Keep availability conditional.
May-August	Late-spring/summer fog sensitivity	Do not promise a daily beach departure.
September-October	Best seasonal sunshine window per NPS	Prioritize small trials, with the same day-of check.
November-December	Return to winter weather pattern	Use selective dates and check rain/wind.

The month groupings are an operating interpretation of broad seasonal guidance, not measured fog frequencies. Fog and wind can occur in any month. A six-week autumn pilot will not establish summer reliability.

Proposed weather routine

Evening before: check a coastal forecast and alerts, likely fog timing, route access and garden service. Prepare a clear guest message. **By 9 AM for an 11 AM start:** decide using a recent beach observation and forecast; recheck before arrival. This deadline remains a proposed policy.

If the sunny-day condition fails before departure, the recommended approach is full refund or a guest-selected reschedule. Do not substitute A/B without agreement. If conditions change en route, follow the disclosed safety and service-recovery policy and record what was delivered.

Keep surf culture interpretation on the shore. No swimming, surfing instruction or water entry is part of the product. Do not use sunshine as a proxy for ocean safety.

Sources: [10] NPS: Ocean Beach weather and visitor guidance



09

Teach Muni, then let guests lead.

Guide-training lesson and end-of-tour learning check

OPENING SCRIPT

We teach you how to enjoy the city the way the locals do. Your transit fare is separate. Let's check what you already have, choose the right option and practice together before the first ride.

Step	Demonstration and guest check
Choose	Check existing passes, youth eligibility and phone access. Explain the Muni-only day pass, daily expiry and exclusions: cable cars, BART and Caltrain are separate.
Tap	For a pass on Clipper, use the same card/device at each boarding or Metro gate and confirm acceptance. Muni does not require tapping out.
Activate	For MuniMobile, activate before boarding or entering the paid area and show the live ticket. It is not tapped on a Clipper reader. Follow station-agent directions.
Paper	For a farebox day pass, tell the operator which product is wanted before inserting exact cash. Keep the paper ticket and show it as directed.
Ride	Check route and destination; let others off. Use the appropriate door for payment, keep aisles/priority seats clear and retain proof of payment.
Transfer	Ask a guest to identify the next route, direction, stop and whether the fare is tapped or shown. Confirm before moving the group.

Finish-line check: each guest can explain their next boarding action, fare expiry and an onward route. Make sure each person retains independent access to their ticket when the group separates.

Payment products are changing. MuniMobile single-ride sales ended September 1, 2026; consult the current transition page before later tours and refresh the teaching script rather than rely on this dated printout.

Sources: [01] SFMTA: fares and day pass | [02] SFMTA: how to ride Muni | [03] SFMTA: MuniMobile transition



10

Build stories around people and places

Interpretive framework and guide assessment

Place / theme	Useful story and factual boundary
Wharf / Alcatraz	The 1962 escape used decoy heads with human hair. Discuss observation and trust without claiming the escapees' fate is established. [40]
North Beach / Chinatown	Migration, gathering places and civic voice. Treat both as living communities; include Rose Pak and transit access without caricature.
Moscone / Steve Jobs	Apple introduced iPhone at Macworld SF in January 2007. Connect interface changes to everyday habits. No private residential address or South Bay detour. [39]
Anthropic / OpenAI	Explain generative AI in plain language, including why an answer may need checking. Reverify company locations and maintain exterior-only scope.
Dogpatch / YC / chips	Connect industrial making to startup experiments. Explain accelerators, AMD and NVIDIA through computing concepts, not investment advice. [38]
Chase / Oracle	Link sports, identity and waterfront change. Use official Warriors, Valkyries and Giants schedules, distinguishing home from away games. [15-17]
West side	Surf culture from shore, the Tea Garden versus Japantown, and Haight-Ashbury's creative history. Corgi Cafe can be a verified optional recommendation, not another required stop.

Train to observable competence

Use one visible place, one sourced fact, one human question and one connection to today. Practice a 90-second talk and a plain-language answer. Admit uncertainty and follow up rather than invent facts.

Before solo guiding, the operator observes a full route rehearsal, Muni teach-back and disruption drill covering a missed vehicle, closed restroom and separated guest. Record safe timings, accessible alternatives and factual corrections; sign off each competency.

Sources: [15] Giants: official game schedule | [16] Warriors: official game schedule | [17] Valkyries: official game schedule | [38] Y Combinator: San Francisco campus | [39] Apple: January 2007 iPhone introduction | [40] FBI: Alcatraz escape decoy heads



11

Deliver a calm, reliable departure

Working procedures to rehearse before paid operation

Before guests arrive

Review bookings, ages, access needs, payments, return buyers and customer messages. Check transit alerts, weather, game crowds, comfort stops and company frontages. Carry a charged phone, power bank, route notes and first-aid supplies appropriate to training. Confirm a contact and separation procedure.

Arrive about 30 minutes early. Use only the agreed meeting/display location. Confirm the branch, duration, walking/transit demands, endpoint and paid-separately purchases. Check every fare before boarding. The pilot allows one total hour around the 3.5-hour guest experience; log actual preparation and closeout.

During the tour

Headcount before boarding, after alighting and after breaks. Keep the group together at crossings and out of doorways. Let a full vehicle leave rather than force boarding. If separated, follow the pre-agreed stop and phone procedure; nobody chases a moving vehicle.

Build in rest and restroom needs. Rehearse an accessible alternative and communicate actual constraints before purchase. Ask before photographing guests or members of the public. Company entrances and private property are not gathering areas without permission.

Closeout and incidents

Complete the onward-Muni lesson, record finish time, actual hours, route changes, spend, refunds and guest feedback. Record incidents factually. For an immediate emergency call 911, provide the location and follow instructions; assist only within training.

Operating risk	Control to test
Transit delay or closure	Buffer, alternate connection and optional-stop cuts.
Coffee queue or no access	Confirmed quick service and replacement comfort stop.
Event crowding	Official home-game check and alternate safe approach.
Owner unavailable	Named qualified backup or prompt operator-cancellation process.
Weather interruption	Coastal check, disclosed policy and documented service recovery.



12

Win the first paying visitors

Positioning, acquisition and the simple customer journey

FIRST TRANSACTION TARGET

Sell one confirmed departure to a party of four for \$596 at the proposed pilot price, or two parties of two. A paid visiting group is a stronger initial signal than compliments from a free rehearsal.

Customer	Reason to choose this tour	Where to test demand
Curious leisure visitor	Contemporary stories and confidence getting beyond the Wharf	Introductions, hotels/hostels and permitted QR placements.
Conference visitor	A compact explanation of the city's AI and startup context	Existing professional contacts and relevant visitor partners.
Sports-oriented visitor	Chase/Oracle waterfront stories and an onward game option	Date-specific official schedules and visitor referrals.

Plan outreach to five to ten suitable visitor-facing partners. Offer accurate information and clear exclusions; obtain permission for small indoor QR cards. Use source codes to see which partners generate paid attendance. No outreach or partner agreement is assumed by this plan.

Start with a **\$180 six-week paid marketing test**. Track ads, referral fees and owner selling hours separately. A target of \$10 or less cash acquisition cost per guest is a channel test ceiling, not permission to exceed the total budget. Add actual commissions to the model.

Make booking easy on a phone

Visitor sees branch, date, price, duration and endpoint; checks availability; confirms ages and exclusions; reviews terms; pays; receives meeting directions and Muni preparation instructions; attends; receives an onward-route recap and optional honest-review request.

Use consistent pricing across website, checkout, signs and partners. Never ask for a positive review as a condition of a benefit. Direct bookings still have selling costs. Test price increases separately after evidence of demand; a \$149 pilot does not validate \$195 willingness to pay. See the next-price test on page 43.



13

A real six-week paid pilot

Recommended launch experiment; not current booking rules

Stage	Action	Evidence
Prepare / about 1-2 weeks	Confirm essentials; run two rehearsals; resolve route and checkout issues. Actual approval readiness sets start date.	16 initial owner hours budgeted; permits, insurance, terms and timing verified.
Weeks 1-2	Offer B Sat/Sun 2-5:30 PM. Four paid guests minimum, eight maximum; proposed \$149 ticket.	Track every offered date, receipt, refund, source and hour.
Week 3 checkpoint	Review the first six offered dates. About 24 paid guests is a useful pace check.	Identify whether weak results concern demand, value, timing or cost.
Weeks 4-6	Repeat the workable format. Change one material variable at a time and record it.	Aim for 60-72 paying guests in total, with at least 48.
End of week 6	Go, revise within a new capped test, or stop expanding.	Assess demand, reliable delivery and actual margins together.

Proposed dates total **12 departures and 96 available seats**. The operating model assumes all 12 run; the scorecard records any canceled dates and adjusts actual costs accordingly. Free rehearsals, comps, refunded bookings and no-shows do not count as delivered paid attendance.

Proposed minimum-departure rule: confirm 48 hours in advance and offer a full refund if the operator cannot run. Offer rescheduling as a guest choice. Finalize and disclose both operator and customer cancellation terms before collecting payment.

Keep A expansion and the C weather-dependent outing outside this first test. Do not build a second staff schedule around unproven demand. The pilot tests its particular season; repeat a limited test in a materially different season before assuming year-round occupancy.



14

Decide with a scorecard

Proposed management thresholds, not industry benchmarks

Measure	Minimum evidence	Stronger expansion signal
Paid demand	48 delivered paid guests; at least 80% outside friends/family	60-72; cost break-even is 43, but 12 four-person departures require 48.
Dates delivered	At least 10 of 12 offered dates run	No low-demand cancellations in final two weeks.
Value	80% good/excellent value at paid price; at least 30 survey responses	Specific praise and independent paid referrals.
Muni learning	80% feel able to make an onward journey	Guests demonstrate direction and fare selection.
Timing	90% finish within 15 minutes of advertised time	Guest duration and total owner hours both meet budget.
Acquisition	Record every source, fee and owner selling hour	Two repeatable sources within actual spending budget.
Economics	Positive actual operating result after all owner hours and costs	20%+ operating margin and credible setup recovery.
Safety / complaints	Record incidents and address unresolved hazards	No unresolved operational issue; zero incidents alone is not proof of safety.

Make the denominator honest

Track all 12 offered dates, including empty and canceled ones. Do not improve apparent occupancy by deleting unsuccessful departures. Track the price actually paid, guests delivered, refunds and comps separately. Survey results need a response count and cannot be assumed to represent every guest.

Expand: add one departure or test a higher price when demand, delivery and economics pass. **Revise:** if guests value it but bookings are weak, run a specific acquisition test with a capped budget. **Redesign:** if value or full-cost economics are weak, fix the offer before adding dates.



15

Starting cash: the lean version

Allowances requiring quotes; existing phone, computer and website assumed

Item	Allowance	Treatment
Registration, guide permit/license and name paperwork	\$900	Initial setup
Initial insurance covering the pilot	\$600	Pilot overhead, paid up front
Focused terms/tax/accounting setup review	\$300	Initial setup
Essential kit, QR printing, setup and rehearsal fares	\$150	Initial setup
Six-week marketing test	\$180	Pilot overhead
Incremental website, phone and administration costs	\$120	Pilot overhead
Working-cash cushion	\$750	Cash retained, not expense
Total starting-cash target	\$3,000	\$2,250 planned spending + \$750 cushion

Initial owner setup time is an additional **16 hours x \$40 = \$640** of economic cost. It is outside the cash target if payment is deferred. Personal living costs require separate runway. Insurance annual minimums or higher permit quotes can increase cash needs; existing paid coverage may reduce incremental funding.

The smallest published 2026-27 SF business-registration tier is \$55 plus a \$4 state fee. Registration is only one part of the paperwork allowance; obtain the current total guide-license/permit quote. First Year Free requires a qualifying commercial location and excludes home-based businesses. Do not assume eligibility or rent premises just for a waiver. [31-33]

The earlier **\$28,428.90** funding scenario supports a much larger schedule and two months of committed costs. It is not the lean pilot minimum. No prior sunk development expense is recovered by the \$3,000 model.

Sources: [31] SF Police Code: guide permits and licensing | [32] SF Treasurer: business registration | [33] SF Treasurer: First Year Free eligibility



16

What it costs to deliver a tour

Management cost categories; owner time remains visible

Four guests at \$149	Basis	Amount
Guide delivery labor	4.5 total hours x \$40	\$180.00
Guide Muni	One day pass	\$5.70
Consumables / materials	4 guests x \$2 allowance	\$8.00
Direct delivery subtotal	Approximately 93% labor	\$193.70
Domestic-card processing	Four transactions at 2.9% + \$0.30	\$18.48
Service-recovery reserve	3% of \$596 sales	\$17.88
Contribution toward overhead / profit	\$596 less the above	\$365.94

The direct delivery subtotal is a narrow management definition of cost of service. Payment/selling expenses and overhead remain visible separately. The 3% reserve is a planning deduction, not an incurred COGS expense or a substitute for funding refunds on undelivered bookings.

Insurance, general administration, website/phone and marketing sit outside this direct-delivery subtotal. Startup costs still have to be recovered. Owner time is costed economically even if it is not paid as wages in the accounting books. Hiring requires a separate employment-cost calculation.

Guests buy their own transit, coffee and admissions, so those purchases add \$0 to operator delivery costs. The \$2 materials figure is an allowance to measure. Add staff, concessions or operator-funded purchases when incurred. The table uses unrounded fee rates before display rounding; actual settled cents may differ slightly.

Sources: [01] SFMTA: fares and day pass | [27] SF: minimum wage effective July 1, 2026 | [28] Stripe: standard processing fees



17

Six-week profit and cash flow

Twelve completed departures; proposed \$149 pilot ticket; no return sales

Average guests	Paid guests	Revenue	Operating surplus	Margin
4	48	\$7,152	\$2,771.23	38.7%
5	60	\$8,940	\$4,426.14	49.5%
6	72	\$10,728	\$6,081.05	56.7%

Cost assumptions: 12 x 4.5 departure hours plus 6 x 3 admin/sales hours = **72 owner hours at \$40 = \$2,880**. Guide fares total \$68.40. Pilot overhead is \$900: insurance \$600, marketing \$180 and web/phone/admin \$120. Per guest: \$2 materials, domestic processing at 2.9% + \$0.30, and a 3% sales reserve.

REPRODUCIBLE CALCULATION

Operating surplus = paid guests x \$137.909 - \$3,848.40.
Full-cost result = operating surplus - \$1,350 initial setup cash - \$640 initial owner setup time. The \$750 cash cushion is not deducted again.

Paid guests	After initial setup and setup labor
48	\$781.23
60	\$2,436.14
72	\$4,091.05

43 paid guests mathematically recover the modeled operating costs, setup and 88 total owner hours. The four-person rule means 12 completed dates require at least 48 guests. At 48, the \$781.23 residual is 26.0% of the \$3,000 funding target; at 72, \$4,091.05 is 136.4%. These are six-week scenarios, not annualized returns or demonstrated demand.

Stripe typically schedules a first payout within 7-14 days and may take longer. Prepayments are not earned profit. Keep undelivered-booking refunds funded and separate receipts, revenue, payouts and owner draws. These pre-tax scenarios exclude prior development spending and unmodeled employment costs; actual processing cents may differ.

Sources: [28] Stripe: standard processing fees | [30] Stripe: payout timing



18

Reduce costs without weakening the tour

Measure the hours saved; do not assume the owner works for free

Action	How it helps	Pilot target
Fill existing departures	Six guests spread largely fixed guide time across more tickets.	Delivery cost per guest: about \$48.43 at four vs \$32.95 at six.
Reusable preparation	Script, checklist and Muni arrival instructions. Preserve 3.5 guest hours.	Save 0.5 hour x 12 x \$40 = \$240.
Standard administration	One calendar and seat ledger; repeatable confirmation/refund messages.	Save 1 hour/week x 6 x \$40 = \$240.
Digital visitor materials	Mobile map and onward-transit recap instead of unnecessary handouts.	Save \$1.50 x 48 guests = \$72.
Control acquisition	Compare actual fees and owner sales time across sources.	An illustrative 20% commission consumes \$119.20 on a \$596 booking.
Simplify the route	Confirmed coffee option, fewer detours and separate optional services.	Reduce overtime and disruption; validate actual labor savings.

POTENTIAL SAVING AT THE SAME 48 GUESTS

\$240 preparation + \$240 administration + \$72 materials = **\$552**. If achieved without new costs, operating surplus rises from \$2,771.23 to **\$3,323.23**, and margin from 38.7% to **46.5%**, before setup and income taxes.

The two extra guests in a six-person group contribute \$275.82 per departure after modeled incremental supplies, fees and reserve, before additional acquisition costs. Higher occupancy lowers unit cost; total cash spending does not fall. Keep the eight-person cap.

Owner time savings improve economic profit; they improve bank cash only when those hours would otherwise have been paid. Do not remove essential coverage or safe operating practices. Direct bookings still require selling work, and a commission channel may be worthwhile when it adds profitable demand.



Scale scenario: monthly profit and ROI

Original full A/B model, retained separately from the launch pilot

Assume 52 departures/month, eight seats each, **208 paying guests** (four per departure) and 25% buying a \$40 return. Cost 267 owner hours at \$40 = \$10,680, plus \$1,217.20 guide fares/overhead. Committed cost = **\$11,897.20/month**. Variable costs: 2.9% + \$0.30 for each ticket and return order, 3% sales reserve and \$2 per guest.

Ticket	Monthly sales	Operating surplus	Margin	1st-year ROI*
\$50	\$12,480	-\$647.52	-5.2%	-43.6%
\$75	\$17,680	\$4,245.68	24.0%	162.9%
\$100	\$22,880	\$9,138.88	39.9%	369.5%
\$125	\$28,080	\$14,032.08	50.0%	576.0%
\$195	\$42,640	\$27,733.04	65.0%	1,154.3%

***A sensitivity calculation, not a forecast.** Every row holds attendance constant although higher prices may reduce demand. Annual results assume 12 identical operating months with no launch ramp-up or seasonal decline. C is excluded. Figures include modeled owner pay, but exclude income tax and unmodeled employment costs.

Funding and calculation basis

Startup allowance \$4,634.50, including 15% contingency, plus two months of committed costs (\$23,794.40) = **\$28,428.90** initial funding. Startup is treated as spent once with no residual asset value; the reserve remains business cash and is not expensed again.

Operating margin = monthly surplus / sales.

First-year ROI = (12 x monthly surplus - \$4,634.50) / \$28,428.90.

At \$100: annual surplus \$109,666.56; gain after startup \$105,032.06; calculated ROI 369.5%. This is not IRR or an after-tax return.

At \$100 the startup allowance equals 0.51 profitable months of modeled surplus; all funding equals 3.11 profitable months. Those ratios do not predict a calendar payback date or mean reserves can be withdrawn. Use pilot actuals before relying on a scale scenario.



20

Stress the demand and pay every hour

Separate downside cases and staffing assumptions

\$100 monthly case	Sales	Surplus	Margin
Two guests/departure; 25% returns	\$11,440	-\$1,379.16	-12.1%
Four guests; 25% returns	\$22,880	\$9,138.88	39.9%
Four guests; no return buyers	\$20,800	\$7,197.20	34.6%
No returns + added 20% channel cost	\$20,800	\$3,037.20	14.6%
Same + 15% labor-cost uplift	\$20,800	\$1,435.20	6.9%

No-return stresses retain all reserved return-guide hours. A workbook scenario removing return service and its labor is a different calculation. The added 20% channel cost is an assumption on top of retained marketing and card charges; real contracts may replace some fees. The 15% labor uplift adds \$1,602 and is not a complete employee payroll model.

At \$100, break-even attendance is 118/month with modeled return purchases, 130 with no returns, 166 with added channel cost and 189 with the labor uplift. In the last case, two months of higher committed costs raises funding to \$31,632.90; modeled first-year ROI falls to 39.8%.

The pilot uses a different labor budget

Model	Departure / admin / setup hours
Six-week launch pilot	4.5 per departure; 3 admin hours/week; 16 initial setup hours.
Original full schedule	4 per departure; 0.75 return hour per departure; 20 admin hours/month; 12 setup hours.

The full schedule totals 267 owner hours/month, about 61.6 per week. Reprice with actual hours and a practical staffing plan before expanding. Preserve the \$40 owner allowance. SF minimum wage is \$19.61 from July 1, 2026; covered employees also require applicable overtime, payroll taxes, leave and workers' compensation. [27,37]

At the updated \$149 pilot price, three extra admin hours/week cost \$720 and reduce four-guest operating surplus to \$2,051.23. If acquisition costs \$10/guest instead of the \$180 allowance, surplus is \$2,471.23. See page 42 for added-commission stress; the monthly table above retains the earlier \$100 scale scenario.

Sources: [27] SF: minimum wage effective July 1, 2026 | [37] California DIR: overtime



21

Returns and Branch C need their own math

Optional products are not assumed in the six-week pilot revenue

The \$40 guided return

At \$40/hour, 45 minutes costs \$30 in guide labor. One \$40 buyer contributes \$37.34 after domestic processing (\$1.46) and a 3% reserve (\$1.20), leaving **\$7.34** after marginal guide time, before extra overhead or delay. The guest's transit fare remains separate. Prebook returns and record actual hours; a later game-night escort is a separate service.

Branch C: exploratory economics only

Four guests at an illustrative \$195	Planning amount
Ticket sales	\$780.00
Guide labor: 5.5 hours x \$40	\$220.00
Guide fare and garden allowance	\$30.70 (\$5.70 + \$25)
Guest materials, processing and reserve	\$55.22
NPS authorization allocated across 16 runs	\$40.625 per run (\$650 / 16)
Contribution before shared overhead/acquisition	\$433.46 (unrounded calculation)

The \$195 C price, \$25 garden cost and 16 annual runs are assumptions, not approved prices or verified garden admission. Guests pay their own fares and entry. The garden allowance here covers the guide. Additional garden/group permissions and costs may apply.

NPS currently lists \$350 annual application plus \$300 per guide for a guided-service placard and asks for 14 business days after complete materials/fees. Confirm the exact authorization, insurance, year and area before selling. Fewer completed outings increase cost allocation: \$650 across eight runs is \$81.25/run. [11]

C excludes shared overhead, acquisition, unrecovered weather cancellations and additional employee costs. If the owner guides C, remove overlapping A/B revenue; if staffed separately, include the additional guide cost. Do not add C revenue to the full A/B scenario without this adjustment.

Sources: [11] NPS: guided-service authorizations and fees | [12] Gardens of Golden Gate Park: tickets



22

Permissions, taxes and clear refund terms

Operator costs and customer charges must be distinguished

Area	Required resolution before paid operation
Guide / business	Confirm the SF Police permit and advance guide license, business registration and name paperwork. Obtain current total fees; the \$900 pilot figure is an allowance. [31,32]
Insurance / locations	Obtain suitable coverage; confirm meeting/standing points, café arrangements and park/garden permissions. NPS authorization is separate where applicable. [11]
Tax treatment	Review the exact service and any bundled goods/admissions. Do not automatically apply retail sales tax or invent a general SF tour tax. Customer-collected government charges are liabilities, not revenue. [35]
Advertised price	Include mandatory operator fees in the advertised price under applicable rules. Separately itemize only verified applicable government transaction charges. [34]
Refunds / minimum	Publish customer cancellation deadlines and refund eligibility, operator cancellation handling, four-person minimum notice and C weather conditions. These policies are not finalized by this plan.
Street advertising	Confirm jurisdiction and specific permission before putting a stand at the Wharf. Port sign guidelines prohibit portable sandwich boards within their scope; no blanket placement permission is assumed. [36]

The intended service approach is flexible refunds. Budget actual processing losses and service recovery, not only a written promise. A proposed operator-cancellation rule is full refund or optional reschedule. Do not require credit or substitute a route without agreement.

Before charging, reconcile the selected price and policies across the website, checkout, confirmation and printed collateral. Tax calculation should remain blocked until classification and configuration are reviewed. No arbitrary municipal surcharge belongs in the revenue model.

Sources: [31] SF Police Code: guide permits and licensing | [32] SF Treasurer: business registration | [34] California DOJ: advertised prices and hidden fees | [35] CDTFA: destination-management services | [36] Port: sign guidelines



23

Booking, payment and backend readiness

A phone-friendly sales path with verified capacity and receipts

Current review status: the site is an owner-private preview, ticket sales are disabled, Stripe live credentials are not configured, and tax treatment, meeting details, contact information and cancellation terms remain launch items. The intended aisftour.com domain must be connected and verified before public QR use.

Workflow	What must work
Calendar	Correct local date, branch, time, capacity, closed Mondays and selected pilot dates. Do not sell C before its own approval and schedule.
Guest review	Age 16+ acknowledgment, party size, exclusions, endpoint, access information and optional return clearly shown.
Price / payment	Server-verified price and capacity; tested Stripe configuration and any applicable reviewed tax settings. Payment completion must not rely only on a browser redirect.
Confirmation	Verified payment status, booking reference, meeting instructions, support contact and calendar details.
Capacity / refunds	Prevent duplicate/oversold seats; reconcile payment events and refunds; release or retain inventory correctly.
Phone usability	Readable touch controls, clear errors and recovery, workable mobile calendar and confirmation, reduced-motion image fallback.

Lean pilot option

A manually managed calendar and matching Stripe Payment Link can validate demand before additional booking software is purchased. Confirm date and party size first, manage temporary holds, and stop payment availability at capacity. Payment Links are included in standard Payments pricing; a generic link is not an inventory system. [29]

Test one complete transaction, confirmation, refund and capacity reconciliation with appropriate test credentials before live sales. Keep secrets outside the repository. Maintain a minimal guest ledger, limited access, backups and a written recovery procedure. Do not collect payment-card details in the guest spreadsheet.

Sources: [28] Stripe: standard processing fees | [29] Stripe: Payment Links | [30] Stripe: payout timing



24

Launch roadmap and brand execution

Expand from observed demand, with a consistent visitor promise

Stage	Commitment	Release evidence
Readiness	Resolve permissions, quotes, route rehearsals, public access and customer terms.	Complete launch checklist and tested booking/refund journey.
Six paid weeks	Run the focused Branch B pilot.	Scorecard, actual owner hours, cash and customer feedback.
Next 30 days	Add one proven departure or separately test a higher price.	Stable delivery and positive margins after acquisition/time.
Later expansion	Rehearse A and select C dates; train backup coverage.	Separate pricing, staffing and weather economics.
Seasonal validation	Repeat a small test under different weather/demand conditions.	Evidence before year-round fixed commitments.

Keep the brand recognizable

BUILDERS. BALLERS. & THE BAY. Use ink, acid lime and light backgrounds, fine pixel/shutter motion and sparse bus, T-train and bridge illustrations. Preserve mobile readability and a reduced-motion alternative. The visitor promise is a contemporary city experience with practical local confidence.

Existing print artwork includes 18 x 24-inch signs and a 24 x 72-inch banner. The earlier compact sign/trailer kit allowance was \$750; defer it for the lean pilot. Use modest permitted QR placements first. Any later outdoor stand needs location permission, suitable wind handling, safe storage and a printer proof.

The QR destination is intended to be <https://aisftour.com>. Verify DNS, HTTPS, anonymous access, accurate prices and a working booking path before printing. Scan a full-size proof on more than one phone. Artwork is not a permit or proof that sales are open.

NEXT DECISION

Confirm the pilot price and quotes, complete the two rehearsals, make the public purchase path work, and sell the first four seats. Use delivered paid tours to decide what deserves further investment.



25

Assumptions and goal-setting register

Stable IDs, evidence, owners and review milestones

ACTUAL RESULTS HAVE NOT BEEN MEASURED

This register records the current planning inputs and proposed goals. No actual pilot attendance, paid hours, survey responses or profit have been supplied. Missing results are not zeros and cannot be marked achieved.

Code	Meaning	How to interpret it
D	Recorded decision	Existing user/business direction; not proof of implementation.
P	Proposal	Recommended test, goal or policy; not an activated selling rule.
E	Estimate / model input	Needs a quote, observation or sensitivity test.
V	Sourced external input	Evidence date is stated; recheck before use.
U	Unresolved	Specific confirmation or operating evidence still needed.

Accountability: owner/operator is the proposed accountable role for every entry. Advisers and vendors can supply evidence; this document does not assign work to them. **Timing:** the pilot start date is not set. Week 1 begins with the first paid operating week after readiness.

For each entry record its actual value or observation, evidence link, review date, next action and decision. Keep prior values in the change log. Update the model and affected customer materials together. Keep private guest and payment records outside public project files.

The six-week pilot is the launch baseline. The original full-schedule model is a separate scenario. Calculated profit and ROI are outputs of assumptions, not evidence that the assumptions are true. Source keys match the reference pages at the end.



26

Offer and demand

Accountable role: owner/operator / actual observations: not recorded

ID / status	Assumption / current value	Validation and review deadline
A01 D	Current A/B website ticket: \$195 per person.	Recorded offer; pilot pricing has not replaced it. Reconcile collateral after a pricing decision. Review: Before sales
A02 P	Pilot ticket: \$149; initial lead product Branch B.	Sep 15 recommendation replaces \$100; not activated. Validate with paid guests. Test \$195 separately using plan page 43. Review: Before sales; week 6
A03 D	Optional guided Wharf return: \$40 per buyer.	Describe as additional guide time; transit fares are separate. Confirm duration and actual take-up. Review: Before sales; each run
A04 D	Guests must be older than 15 (16+); maximum eight guests.	Check age acknowledgment and capacity; finalize under-18 and access arrangements. Review: Before sales
A05 D	A/B guest experience: 3.5 hours; fares, coffee and admissions extra.	Check itinerary timing and every customer price/exclusion statement. Review: Rehearsals; each run
A06 D	Regular A/B brand schedule: Tuesday-Sunday, no Mondays.	Distinguish the proposed two-day pilot from a fully staffed regular schedule. Review: Before calendar release
A07 P	Curious visitors will value contemporary stories and Muni confidence.	Test with paid visitors outside the owner's personal circle, not only rehearsal feedback. Review: Weeks 3 and 6
A08 U	Actual price elasticity and annual demand are unknown.	Compare like-for-like price tests; label seasonal results separately. Do not hold occupancy constant as a forecast. Review: Before price/scale changes

Status: D recorded decision; P proposal; E estimate; V sourced input; U unresolved. Recheck external inputs before use. Record observed value, evidence and date in the editable tracker; these rows do not show achieved results.



27

Routes and experience

Accountable role: owner/operator / actual observations: not recorded

ID / status	Assumption / current value	Validation and review deadline
A09 E	A: 8:30 AM-12 PM, Wharf to Ferry Building; planned 210 minutes.	Time all walks, T connection, interpretation and comfort stops. Use page 5 as the draft itinerary. Review: Before A sales
A10 E	B: 2-5:30 PM, Wharf to Oracle Park; planned 210 minutes.	Time the draft 60-minute Wharf-Dogpatch transit leg and all later stops; shorten optional detours if necessary. Review: Two rehearsals
A11 U	Exact meeting, standing, restroom and accessible alternatives remain unconfirmed.	Field-check addresses, walking distance, gradients, crossings and site permissions; publish real constraints. Review: Before sales
A12 D	Company stops are exterior stories; no office access or affiliation.	Recheck public frontage and company occupancy; never treat an earlier address as permanent. Review: Before each departure
A13 D	South Bay locations are stories, not visits.	Keep residential addresses and South Bay detours out of the route and sales promise. Review: Each script revision
A14 U	RH coffee-only service within 20 minutes is not confirmed.	Ask about group size, service and restrooms; arrange a substitute. Coffee is guest-paid; no seating guarantee. Review: Before selling the stop
A15 P	A digital recap and personalized onward directions can add value.	Time the work, confirm the deliverable exists, and measure guest usefulness before advertising it as included. Review: Before inclusion; week 3
A16 E	Stadium crowds, transit interruptions and café queues may disrupt timing.	Check official home-game schedules and service alerts; rehearse alternate approaches and missed-vehicle procedures. Review: Each departure

Status: D recorded decision; P proposal; E estimate; V sourced input; U unresolved. Recheck external inputs before use. Record observed value, evidence and date in the editable tracker; these rows do not show achieved results.



28

Pilot labor and delivery inputs

Accountable role: owner/operator / actual observations: not recorded

ID / status	Assumption / current value	Validation and review deadline
A17 P	Six paid weeks, two B departures/week: 12 offered dates, 96 seats.	Select actual dates after readiness; pilot day 1 is the first paid operating day. No calendar start is set. Review: Before sales
A18 P	Four paid guests required; eight maximum.	Disclose the minimum and notice deadline; track offered dates that cannot run. Review: Before sales; each date
A19 E	Pilot financial table assumes all 12 departures run.	Actuals must retain canceled dates and replace costs with actual hours and spend. Review: Weekly
A20 E	One owner-guide; 4.5 total hours per departure at \$40/hour.	Log preparation, check-in, guiding, travel for work and closeout; record any uncovered time. Review: Each departure
A21 E	Administration/selling: three owner hours/week for six weeks.	Log bookings, marketing, customer support and bookkeeping separately from guiding. Review: Weekly
A22 E	Initial setup/rehearsals: 16 owner hours at \$40 = \$640.	Keep initial hours separate from operating labor; deferring owner payment does not eliminate economic cost. Review: Before launch; weekly
A23 E	Consumables: \$2 per guest; one \$5.70 guide day pass per departure.	Keep receipts and check whether existing fare coverage changes actual cost. Guest purchases are excluded. Review: Each departure
A24 E	Pilot transaction model: one domestic-card payment per guest; 3% sales reserve.	Replace with actual processing mix and service recovery. Reserve is not incurred COGS or full refund coverage. Review: Weekly

Status: D recorded decision; P proposal; E estimate; V sourced input; U unresolved. Recheck external inputs before use. Record observed value, evidence and date in the editable tracker; these rows do not show achieved results.



29

Starting-cash allowances

Accountable role: owner/operator / actual observations: not recorded

ID / status	Assumption / current value	Validation and review deadline
A25 E	Guide permits, registration and name paperwork: \$900.	Obtain current itemized fees and required applications; this is not an official fee quote. Review: Before committing spend
A26 E	Initial insurance covering six weeks: \$600.	Obtain terms and premium quote; annual minimums may require more upfront cash. Count it once in pilot overhead. Review: Before paid operation
A27 E	Focused terms/tax/accounting setup review: \$300.	Confirm the scope and quote; add any extra required professional work. Review: Before sales
A28 E	Essential kit, QR printing, setup and rehearsal fares: \$150.	Use a purchase list and receipts; deduct usable equipment already owned. Review: Before purchases
A29 E	Six-week marketing: \$180; incremental web/phone/admin: \$120.	Separate cash selling costs from owner hours. Add actual referral commissions without duplicating fees. Review: Before campaign; weekly
A30 P	Working-cash cushion: \$750; starting-cash target: \$3,000.	Target equals \$2,250 planned spend plus cushion. Check payout delays and liabilities before owner draws. Review: Before launch; weekly
A31 E	Existing website, phone and computer are available; no new rent/vehicle/staff.	Confirm incremental costs; a new subscription, employee or rental requires a revised budget. Review: Before any commitment
A32 U	Personal runway, actual prior investment and owner draw needs are unrecorded.	Enter available business cash and personal runway privately. Prior sunk spending is outside pilot recovery calculations. Review: Before funding decision

Status: D recorded decision; P proposal; E estimate; V sourced input; U unresolved. Recheck external inputs before use. Record observed value, evidence and date in the editable tracker; these rows do not show achieved results.



30

External commercial inputs

Accountable role: owner/operator / actual observations: not recorded

ID / status	Assumption / current value	Validation and review deadline
A33 V	SF minimum wage: \$19.61/hour from July 1, 2026. [27]	Source rechecked September 15. Preserve the higher \$40 planning allowance; employment costs require a separate calculation. Review: Before hiring; wage updates
A34 V	Muni day pass: \$5.70; regular Muni free for ages 18 and under. [01]	Source checked September 14. Confirm current fare and eligibility; do not require an unnecessary guest pass. Review: Before fare teaching
A35 V	Stripe domestic cards: 2.9% + \$0.30 per successful transaction. [28]	Rechecked September 15. International cards add 1.5%; conversion can add 1%. Inspect actual card mix and fees. Review: Setup; monthly
A36 V	Payment Links included in standard Payments pricing. [29]	Source checked September 14. Avoid assuming optional invoicing, custom domains or other products are free. Review: Before checkout selection
A37 V	Initial Stripe payout typically 7-14 days and can take longer. [30]	Check account-specific expected deposit dates; booking receipts do not equal available bank cash. Review: First payment; each payout
A38 V	Smallest 2026-27 SF registration tier: \$55 + \$4 state fee. [32]	Source checked September 14. Verify applicable tier and other license/name charges; not the total startup fee. Review: Registration
A39 V	First Year Free excludes home-based businesses. [33]	Source checked September 14. Check all eligibility criteria; no waiver is assumed in the budget. Review: Registration
A40 E	Benchmarks checked September 9-15; food/bike/Santa Fe rechecked Sep 15. [18-26]	They are not final checkout quotes. Confirm inclusions and conflicting prices before publishing comparisons. Review: Before reuse

Status: D recorded decision; P proposal; E estimate; V sourced input; U unresolved. Recheck external inputs before use. Record observed value, evidence and date in the editable tracker; these rows do not show achieved results.



31

Permissions and customer policies

Accountable role: owner/operator / actual observations: not recorded

ID / status	Assumption / current value	Validation and review deadline
A41 U	Guide permit/license, business registration and coverage are not evidenced as complete.	Obtain appropriate documents and current total fees; registration alone does not establish launch readiness. [31,32] Review: Before paid operation
A42 U	Tax classification and any applicable customer transaction tax remain unresolved.	Review actual service/bundles and configure verified treatment. Do not invent a general SF tour tax. [35] Review: Before checkout opens
A43 D	Mandatory operator charges belong in the advertised total under applicable rules.	Reconcile web, payment and print prices. Verified government transaction charges may be itemized separately. [34] Review: Before sales
A44 P	Minimum-departure confirmation 48 hours ahead.	Finalize operational deadline and disclose it before payment; do not silently cancel or force a different date. Review: Before terms publication
A45 P	Operator cancellation: full refund or guest-selected reschedule.	Finalize customer cancellation windows, post-start remedies and processing-cost treatment; flexible refunds are the intended approach. Review: Before sales
A46 U	Wharf display location and required permissions are unconfirmed.	Check the exact jurisdiction; Port sign restrictions can prohibit sandwich boards. Small QR placement also needs permission. [36] Review: Before any placement
A47 U	Public site/domain, contact details and live checkout are not launch-ready.	Verify anonymous access, correct dates/prices, support contact, payment, confirmation, refund and seat reconciliation. Review: Before advertising sales
A48 P	Guest data and refund cash will be controlled separately.	Use a minimal access-limited ledger and backups; keep unearned-booking funds available. Never store card details. Review: Before booking; weekly

Status: D recorded decision; P proposal; E estimate; V sourced input; U unresolved. Recheck external inputs before use. Record observed value, evidence and date in the editable tracker; these rows do not show achieved results.



32

Branch C and weather

Accountable role: owner/operator / actual observations: not recorded

ID / status	Assumption / current value	Validation and review deadline
A49 P	C is a separate sunny, fog-free beach outing; no casual A/B extension.	Confirm coastal conditions, exact scope and independent staffing. South Bay locations remain stories. Review: Before C sale; each run
A50 E	C draft: 11 AM-3:30 PM, 270 minutes from Ocean Beach to Japantown.	Rehearse the full N/7/22 sequence, garden visit and walking; no Wharf return is assumed. Review: Before C sales
A51 V	Ocean Beach is fog-sensitive in late spring/summer; September/October are sunniest. [10]	Source rechecked September 14. Month labels are qualitative guidance, not measured monthly probabilities. Review: Season planning; day of
A52 P	C weather decision by 9 AM for an 11 AM start.	Use local forecast plus a recent beach observation; define the policy and subsequent fog response before sales. Review: Before C terms; day of
A53 V	Outerlands: weekend brunch 9:30 AM-2 PM; max seated party eight, walk-in. [14]	Rechecked September 14. Eight guests plus guide exceed this cap; confirm takeaway or another workable arrangement. Review: Before C dates
A54 E	C illustrative price \$195; 5.5 total owner hours at \$40; 4-8 guests.	No selling price selected. Use its own paid demand and time test; exclude shared overhead from contribution only explicitly. Review: Before C pricing
A55 E	C guide garden allowance \$25 plus \$5.70 fare; 16 completed runs/year assumed.	Confirm actual garden ticket/guide entry and permissions. Fewer runs increase annual-cost allocation. Review: Before C budget
A56 V	NPS guided-service application \$350 + \$300/guide; allow 14 business days. [11]	Rechecked September 14. Confirm applicability, authorization year, insurance and complete application; not automatic approval. Review: Before C sale

Status: D recorded decision; P proposal; E estimate; V sourced input; U unresolved. Recheck external inputs before use. Record observed value, evidence and date in the editable tracker; these rows do not show achieved results.



33

Full-schedule model assumptions

Accountable role: owner/operator / actual observations: not recorded

ID / status	Assumption / current value	Validation and review deadline
A57 E	52 departures/month: two/day, six days/week, 52/12 weeks/month.	Separate scale scenario, not pilot schedule. Cost all offered dates; validate season and staffing before release. Review: Before expansion
A58 E	Eight seats each; 416 capacity; base 208 paid guests (four/departure).	No observed occupancy supplied. Demand may change with price; do not assume the same sales across price rows. Review: After pilot; each price test
A59 E	Return purchase share 25% at \$40; each ticket/return a separate payment.	Measure actual take-up, group orders and card mix; core ticket should also work without returns. Review: After each paid run
A60 E	Full schedule: 4 owner hours/departure; 0.75 return hour/departure.	Different from pilot's 4.5 hours and no return baseline. Includes 39 reserved return hours/month. Review: Before scale budget
A61 E	Full schedule admin 20 hours/month; total 267 hours at \$40 = \$10,680.	About 61.6 owner hours/week. Check realistic capacity; hiring needs separate payroll and overtime costing. Review: Before expansion
A62 E	Guide fares: 26 operating days x \$5.70 = \$148.20/month.	One pass per day, not per A/B tour, in this scale model. Replace with the actual fare product. Review: Before scale budget
A63 E	Scale startup \$4,030 + 15% contingency = \$4,634.50.	Earlier selected equipment/setup scope, not lean cash minimum. Requote; do not combine both startup budgets. Review: Before scale funding
A64 E	Two months committed-cost reserve \$23,794.40; total funding \$28,428.90.	Reserve remains cash and is not expensed again. Owner labor included even if draws are deferred. Review: Before scale funding

Status: D recorded decision; P proposal; E estimate; V sourced input; U unresolved. Recheck external inputs before use. Record observed value, evidence and date in the editable tracker; these rows do not show achieved results.



34

Scale overhead and scenario limits

Accountable role: owner/operator / actual observations: not recorded

ID / status	Assumption / current value	Validation and review deadline
A65 E	Monthly overhead: insurance \$180; web/domain/hosting \$35; booking tools \$39.	Unquoted scale assumptions; use actual contracts. Distinct from \$600 initial pilot insurance and \$120 pilot admin cash. Review: Before scale budget
A66 E	Monthly overhead: phone \$30; bookkeeping \$120; equipment reserve \$40.	Verify incremental spend and owner work already counted; avoid duplicate cost allocation. Review: Before scale budget
A67 E	Monthly marketing \$600; license/admin reserve \$25; rent \$0.	Overhead totals \$1,069; guide fare raises nonlabor committed costs to \$1,217.20. Add actual channel costs. Review: Before scale budget
A68 E	Scale variables: \$2 materials/guest and 3% sales reserve; domestic card baseline.	Retain the same assumption definitions when comparing prices; disclose added fees and refund losses. Review: Each scenario revision
A69 E	Annual ROI assumes 12 identical months with no ramp-up or seasonal decline.	Sensitivity only, not forecast. No residual startup-asset value; working-capital reserve stays held. Review: Before presenting returns
A70 E	Stress: no return buyers but all return time retained; +20% channel expense.	Added channel rate is hypothetical and retains card/marketing costs; actual contracts may replace some fees. Review: Before channel decision
A71 E	Stress: +15% labor cost (\$1,602/month), not complete employee payroll.	Recalculate required payroll/overtime/coverage from an actual staffing plan; stress funding rises to \$31,632.90. Review: Before hiring
A72 E	Income tax, financing, prior sunk costs and unmodeled employment costs excluded.	Record actual obligations separately. Government charges collected for remittance are not tour revenue. Review: Before profitability claims

Status: D recorded decision; P proposal; E estimate; V sourced input; U unresolved. Recheck external inputs before use. Record observed value, evidence and date in the editable tracker; these rows do not show achieved results.



35

Efficiency, branding and expansion

Accountable role: owner/operator / actual observations: not recorded

ID / status	Assumption / current value	Validation and review deadline
A73 P	Reduce prep from 4.5 to 4 total hours per departure, preserving 3.5 guest hours.	Time-log target: 0.5 hour x 12 x \$40 = \$240 economic saving; add any new setup cost. Review: Weeks 3 and 6
A74 P	Reduce admin from three to two hours/week.	Target saving: six hours x \$40 = \$240. Count selling, support and booking work honestly. Review: Weeks 3 and 6
A75 P	Reduce materials from \$2 to \$0.50/guest.	At 48 guests target \$72 saving; test quality and actual receipts. No achieved saving is recorded. Review: Weeks 3 and 6
A76 P	Combined efficiency target \$552; \$149 pilot surplus \$2,771.23 could become \$3,323.23.	Only with the same 48 guests, all three improvements and no offsetting costs. Actual results are unmeasured. Review: Week 6
A77 D	Brand: BUILDERS. BALLERS. & THE BAY.; fine pixel motion and sparse transit icons.	Review mobile legibility and reduced-motion behavior; keep visitor instructions clear. Review: Each design release
A78 E	Earlier sign/trailer kit \$750; 18x24 sign and 24x72 banner artwork exist.	Defer hardware in lean pilot; quote outdoor system, storage and legal placement before purchase. Review: Before printing/purchase
A79 U	QR uses intended aisftour.com domain; production destination unverified.	Test DNS, HTTPS, anonymous access, selected offer and purchase on multiple phones before public printing. Review: Before public QR use
A80 P	Expand one date/product at a time; C cannot overlap owner-led A/B without a second guide.	Remove displaced A/B revenue or add actual staffing cost. Repeat a different-season test before annual commitments. Review: Week 6; each expansion

Status: D recorded decision; P proposal; E estimate; V sourced input; U unresolved. Recheck external inputs before use. Record observed value, evidence and date in the editable tracker; these rows do not show achieved results.



36

Readiness and paid demand goals

All goals proposed / actual baseline: not measured / owner: operator

Goal	Target	Measurement and review
G01 Ready for paid operation	All launch requirements evidenced; no unresolved release blocker.	Permit/registration, insurance, site access, customer terms, tax treatment and end-to-end checkout evidence. Review: Before first sale
G02 Rehearse the route	Two full B rehearsals; timings, alternatives and teaching checks recorded.	Dated route logs, actual walking/transit/coffee time and guide sign-off. Review: Before first paid departure
G03 Make the first sale	Four paid seats at the selected pilot price; \$596 if \$149 is adopted.	Booking/payment records and customer terms acceptance; exclude complimentary seats. Review: First confirmed departure
G04 Midpoint demand check	About 24 delivered paid guests across first six offered dates.	Guest ledger including empty/canceled dates; investigate weak demand rather than add routes. Review: End of week 3
G05 Paid pilot attendance	At least 48; target 60-72 across all 12 offered dates.	Delivered paid attendance only; exclude comps, refunds and no-shows; retain all offered dates. Review: End of week 6
G06 Independent demand	At least 80% of delivered paid guests outside friends/family.	Optional relationship/source flag in booking ledger; unknowns do not count as independent evidence. Review: Weeks 3 and 6

These are internal decision targets, not industry standards or guaranteed results. Keep all offered dates in the demand record, report survey denominators, and track owner time separately. Review goals prospectively; do not change the denominator after the fact to manufacture success.



37

Delivery and acquisition goals

All goals proposed / actual baseline: not measured / owner: operator

Goal	Target	Measurement and review
G07 Reliable departures	At least 10/12 run; stretch: no low-demand cancellations in final two weeks.	Departure log showing all 12 dates, reasons and notices; reconcile actual costs for canceled dates. Review: Weekly; week 6
G08 Value at the paid price	At least 80% good/excellent value, with at least 30 completed responses.	Anonymous survey: positive value answers / all completed value answers; report response count/rate. Review: Weeks 3 and 6
G09 Muni confidence	At least 80% can report confidence making an onward trip; seek 30+ responses.	Survey plus optional route/fare teach-back; distinguish observed skill from self-reported confidence. Review: Each run; week 6
G10 Finish on time	At least 90% of completed tours finish within 15 minutes of advertised time.	Timestamp log; report completed-tour denominator separately from canceled dates. Review: Weekly; week 6
G11 Protect paid owner time	Budget 4.5 hours/run, 3 admin hours/week and 16 setup hours; log all actual hours.	Timesheet: setup, preparation, guiding, returns and admin. Rebudget if actual time exceeds allowance. Review: Each run; weekly
G12 Affordable acquisition	Pilot cash marketing budget \$180; test channels at <=\$10 per paid guest.	Attribute spend and paid attendance by source; count owner time separately. Stretch: two repeatable sources. Review: Weekly; week 6

These are internal decision targets, not industry standards or guaranteed results. Keep all offered dates in the demand record, report survey denominators, and track owner time separately. Review goals prospectively; do not change the denominator after the fact to manufacture success.



38

Financial and decision goals

All goals proposed / actual baseline: not measured / owner: operator

Goal	Target	Measurement and review
G13 Operating profitability	Positive actual operating surplus; stronger expansion target $\geq 20\%$ margin.	Delivered sales less actual costs and all owner hours at \$40. Reconcile reserve vs actual losses; avoid double counts. Review: Weeks 3 and 6
G14 Recover startup investment	Recover actual initial setup and operating costs including owner time; 43 guests mathematically, but 48 to run all 12 dates at minimum.	Recalculate break-even after quotes/time logs. Keep cost break-even separate from the four-guest departure rule. Review: End of pilot; next review
G15 Demonstrate cost savings	Test the \$552 efficiency opportunity without reducing the guest experience.	Compare prep, admin and materials actuals to baseline; deduct any added setup/software costs. Review: Weeks 3 and 6
G16 Resolve operating hazards	Record every incident/complaint and resolve critical issues before the next departure.	Incident log, action owner and closure evidence; zero incidents is not proof of safety. Review: Each run; before next
G17 Maintain refund liquidity	Available funds cover undelivered-booking refunds and obligations due before next reliable payout.	Cash, processor balance, payout date and liability reconciliation; check before owner draws. Review: Weekly; before draws
G18 Make an expansion decision	Written go/revise/stop decision based on demand, delivery and economics together.	Week-6 review; any follow-up test has its own budget and deadline. No automatic expansion or annualization. Review: End of week 6

These are internal decision targets, not industry standards or guaranteed results. Keep all offered dates in the demand record, report survey denominators, and track owner time separately. Review goals prospectively; do not change the denominator after the fact to manufacture success.



39

Keep a weekly evidence and decision log

A working record to complete after each operating week

Record	Required entry
Date and scope	Review date, pilot week, offered/completed/canceled dates and reasons.
Demand	Delivered paid guests, comps, no-shows, refunded bookings and price actually paid.
Cash and labor	Receipts, delivered revenue, unearned/refund liabilities, costs and all owner hours by category.
Experience	Survey counts, value and Muni answers, start/finish times, incidents and follow-up.
Acquisition	Spend and paid attendance by source; include owner selling time separately.
Changed assumptions	ID, old value, new observation, evidence/date and affected calculations.
Decision	Go/revise/stop or specific next test; accountable role, due date and budget.

Decision log - September 14-15, 2026

September 14: created **80 assumptions** and **18 goals** with a \$100 pilot proposal. September 15: A02 becomes a proposed \$149 pilot; dependent economics, G03 and G14 are revised. The website remains \$195 with sales closed. No actual pilot results or external assignments are recorded.

At week 3, diagnose whether demand, value, delivery or costs need work. At week 6, make a written decision using all three: paid demand, reliable delivery and actual economics. A follow-up experiment needs its own spending limit and deadline. Keep any sensitive evidence in an access-controlled operational record.

Use the companion editable Markdown tracker to enter actuals and preserve changes. An assumption is validated only to the extent supported by its evidence; a goal is achieved only when the measurement meets the stated target.



40

Is the tour too cheap?

Pricing reassessment / September 15, 2026 / recommendation, not a live change

KEEP \$195 AS THE STANDARD-PRICE HYPOTHESIS

Do not raise the shared A/B ticket above \$195 yet. Replace the earlier \$100 pilot recommendation with a clearly limited **\$149 founding pilot**. Paid demand must establish the sustainable standard price.

Price	Role and decision
\$100	Earlier pilot proposal. Can cover operations with enough attendance, but four guests/run leave a loss after setup. Not the recommended ongoing price.
\$149	Recommended six-week Branch B test: 12 dates, 4-8 guests, same 3.5-hour experience. More room for guide pay and startup recovery.
\$195	Existing website price and next paid test if the pilot succeeds. Already a premium relative to several equipment/food-inclusive local options.
\$225+	Future test only after repeatable \$195 demand and strong value feedback; no present evidence that this market will support it.

Price for demonstrated guest value

The modeled \$195 ticket has substantial cost coverage at four guests; the unresolved issue is whether visitors will buy it. Our 3.5-hour shared walk/Muni format includes no vehicle, meal, guest fare or office access. A compelling guide and specialist interpretation can command a premium, but a list of company buildings alone cannot prove it.

Heritage Inspirations charges \$195 plus tax in Santa Fe with an e-bike, gear, a six-person maximum and a return to the start. This is a useful quality reference, not evidence that SF visitors will pay more for different inclusions. Local food and e-bike comparisons on page 4 reinforce that distinction. [20,22-24,26]

Sell \$149 honestly as a limited pilot with fixed dates and a clear endpoint. Do not advertise a fabricated former price, guaranteed savings or a permanent \$195 value already established by sales. The website remains \$195 with sales closed pending a separate selling-price decision.



41

Price sensitivity on the same cost base

48 delivered guests / 12 completed departures / four guests each / no returns

Ticket	Sales	Operating surplus	Op. margin	After setup	Full-cost guests*
\$100	\$4,800.00	\$558.00	11.6%	-\$1,432.00	64
\$125	\$6,000.00	\$1,687.20	28.1%	-\$302.80	51
\$149	\$7,152.00	\$2,771.23	38.7%	\$781.23	43
\$175	\$8,400.00	\$3,945.60	47.0%	\$1,955.60	36
\$195	\$9,360.00	\$4,848.96	51.8%	\$2,858.96	33
\$225	\$10,800.00	\$6,204.00	57.4%	\$4,214.00	28

*Minimum whole guests across the six weeks to recover modeled operations plus setup, while retaining all 12 departures' costs. The four-guest departure rule is separate: 12 completed departures require at least 48 guests. Higher prices do not guarantee unchanged attendance.

One formula makes the comparison reproducible

Contribution per guest = **0.941 x ticket price - \$2.30**: price less 2.9% domestic processing, 3% recovery reserve, \$0.30 transaction fee and \$2 materials. Operating surplus = guests x contribution - **\$3,848.40**. Full-cost result deducts another **\$1,990** for setup cash and initial owner labor.

At \$149	48 guests	60 guests	72 guests
Operating surplus	\$2,771.23	\$4,426.14	\$6,081.05
Operating margin	38.7%	49.5%	56.7%
After setup / initial labor	\$781.23	\$2,436.14	\$4,091.05
Six-week residual / \$3,000 funding	26.0%	81.2%	136.4%

The funding ratio is a scenario return after owner time, not annualized ROI, a guaranteed cash distribution or a forecast. The \$750 cash cushion remains held and is not expensed twice. Unearned ticket receipts remain available for refunds. Income taxes, prior development costs and unmodeled employee costs are excluded.

Calculations retain unrounded percentage fees and round displayed totals; actual transaction-level cents and grouped payments can differ slightly. No measured bookings or supplier quotes validate the estimates.



42

Higher prices must survive lower demand

Cost floors and demand thresholds are planning tools, not market valuations

Comparison	Contribution equivalence, same dates and costs
\$100 to \$149	48 guests at \$149 produce slightly more contribution than 72 at \$100. A smaller group can work, if enough dates still meet the minimum.
\$149 to \$195	\$195 must retain at least 76.1% of \$149 paid attendance to preserve total contribution. Example: 55 guests at \$195 beat 72 at \$149.
\$195 to \$225	\$225 must retain at least 86.5% of \$195 paid attendance. Example: at least 63 guests versus 72. Losing more than about 13.5% erases the increase.

These ratios assume identical fixed costs, acquisition and refund rates, and the same number of offered dates. Guest distribution matters: a financially attractive total can still leave individual dates below the four-person minimum. Do not remove unsuccessful dates from the denominator.

The \$149 four-guest case under pressure

Six-week case / 48 guests	Operating surplus	After setup
Base plan	\$2,771.23	\$781.23
Extra three admin hours/week at \$40	\$2,051.23	\$61.23
\$10 acquisition/guest replacing \$180 allowance	\$2,471.23	\$481.23
Extra 20% sales commission on every ticket	\$1,340.83	-\$649.17
Extra 20% commission plus added admin above	\$620.83	-\$1,369.17

The 20% channel fee is a hypothetical added cost, not a supplier quote; card charges and the original marketing allowance remain in those rows. International cards add 1.5% under published Stripe standard pricing; if all \$7,152 sales used them, that adds \$107.28, before any currency conversion. [28]

Conditional cost floors: at 48 guests, about \$131.71 covers all modeled operating and setup costs; with an added 20% commission it takes about \$167.26. These rounded-up floors leave essentially no safety margin and do not establish willingness to pay. Keep owner labor at \$40/hour; the verified SF minimum wage is \$19.61 from July 1, 2026. Hiring needs its own loaded payroll budget. [27]



43

Test the price before making it permanent

Proposed management gates / small samples are directional evidence

Stage	Price and evidence to collect
Initial six weeks	Offer all 12 Branch B dates at \$149 with the same scope and terms. Count every offered date. Target 60-72 delivered paid guests; minimum 48 and at least 10/12 dates delivered.
Value and execution	At least 80% good/excellent value from 30+ completed surveys, at least 80% independent guests, 90% finishes within 15 minutes, and actual operating margin of 20%+ after every owner hour.
Test \$195 next	If the pilot meets the stronger 60-72 guest target and the quality/economics gates, offer four comparable dates at \$195. Retain the four-person departure minimum. Do not alter route, inclusions or channels simultaneously.
\$195 decision	Seek at least 24 delivered guests over the four offered dates, at least 15 value responses with 80% positive, and the same timing/margin gates. Compare contribution per offered date with the pilot. Do not call this statistical proof.
Possible \$225 test	Consider only after the \$195 block passes and repeat demand supports at least six paid guests/date. Budget another limited test; the allowable attendance loss is only about 13.5% at equal costs.

Capture the evidence that explains the result

Record offered/completed/canceled dates, available seats, price paid, independent guests, sales source, marketing spend, selling hours, refunds and reason, full time logs and survey counts. Count qualified booking-page visits or dated inquiries consistently so a conversion change can be separated from traffic change. Compare similar weekdays, lead times and seasons.

If \$195 fails but \$149 delivers satisfactory value and actual profit, keep testing \$149 as a possible standard price or test \$175 separately. If \$149 demand is weak, investigate the audience, route and offer before cutting price. A private or corporate product needs its own scope, minimum booking and cost model; it is not validated by shared-tour figures.

DECISION RECORDED, IMPLEMENTATION PENDING

September 15: \$149 replaces the prior \$100 recommendation in this plan and assumptions register. The \$195 website price, \$40 optional return, guest-paid coffee/fares and closed-sales status are unchanged. Pilot success will not by itself validate \$195 or year-round demand.



44

What visitors can buy near the Wharf

Published asking prices checked September 15, 2026 / USD / not checkout quotes

Substitute	Price and format	What it means for AI SF
Painted Ladies [41]	\$85 adult / 2 h. Small-group VW tour, water/snacks; Wharf pickup.	Visible transport and familiar city sights for less than half of \$195.
Dylan city + Muir Woods [42]	From \$99 / 4 h. Vehicle transport; adult park entry extra \$15.	About \$114 with listed adult entry before other charges; broad sightseeing competition.
Dylan + Alcatraz [43]	From \$189 for city/Muir Woods and official Alcatraz-ticket combination.	Near our \$195 seat price with an iconic attraction; duration and scope differ.
Secret Food Tours [44]	\$79.99 / 3-3.5 h. North Beach/Chinatown tastings; max 12.	A concrete food-inclusive purchase in nearby visitor neighborhoods.
Bay City Bike [23]	\$115 / 3-4 h. E-bike, guide and bonus rental; Wharf start.	Equipment and transport are tangible included value.
Dandyhorse [22]	From \$99 / about 3-3.5 h. E-bike/pastry; max eight.	The eight-guest cap alone does not justify a \$195 price.

These are different products, dates and customer segments. Listed starting prices may not be available for a chosen date; final checkout fees, remaining taxes and inventories were not verified. They are evidence of alternatives, not competitors' realized revenue, occupancy or profitability.

MARKET INTERPRETATION

For a casual Wharf visitor, \$195 is a substantial purchase. An AI-focused experience must win on the guide's expertise, useful explanations and personal attention. The new research does not establish that \$225 or more will sell reliably.

Research method: compare official operator descriptions, unit of sale, duration and inclusions; retain inconsistent or unavailable prices as unresolved. Do not use stale search snippets or an unrendered \$0 booking widget as a market price. Earlier comparisons and sources remain on page 4.



45

Private tours set a second comparison

Total group prices must not be compared as if they were individual tickets

Operator / published offer	Group price	Scope and qualification
SF Tour Co bespoke [45]	\$675 / up to six	Three-hour private electric VW van, guide and tailored route; specified SF pickup.
SF Native private [46,47]	From \$499 on private page; \$399 in catalog	Custom local walking experiences. Pages conflict; verify a quote before using either as a firm current rate.
Extranomical Silicon Valley [25]	\$1,750 / up to eight	Typically 10-11 hours, private vehicle and SF-area pickup. Different duration and destination.

A family compares the total bill

Four \$195 shared tickets cost **\$780** before guest-paid fares and coffee. Four \$225 tickets cost **\$900**. A family may compare those totals with a \$675 private van, even though the stories and format differ. Calling the offer small-group or premium cannot erase that choice.

A two-person A/B booking at \$195 costs **\$401.40 with two \$5.70 passes**, or **\$481.40 with two \$40 returns**, before coffee and any legally applicable transaction taxes. At \$225, those subtotals become **\$461.40** and **\$541.40**. Show the complete visitor commitment clearly.

Where a higher total sale could work

Prebooked AI enthusiasts and conference groups may pay for a tailored discussion, a credible specialist and a time-efficient itinerary. This is an inference about product fit, not measured demand. A private quote must state the buyer's outcome, group limit, 3.5 guest hours, preparation and exclusions.

Context currently states that it is not running San Francisco tours; no current Context price is used as a premium benchmark. No verified, directly comparable 3.5-hour AI walk/Muni price or local paid-demand dataset was found. A market ceiling therefore cannot be established from this desk research. [48]



46

Recommended test prices by branch

Planning judgment from the comparisons / no website or checkout price change

Offer	Working price	Upper test and condition
Branch A / 3.5 h	\$149-\$175 first price tests	\$195 after a successful A-specific paid test. Familiar neighborhoods face many substitutes; validate the AI narrative.
Branch B / 3.5 h	\$149 founding pilot; \$195 standard-price target	\$225 after repeatable \$195 bookings, strong value feedback and timely delivery. Best initial product to test the specialist promise.
Branch C / 4.5 h	\$195 provisional proposal	\$225 only after timing, permissions, weather policy and paid value are proved. More time is not automatic willingness to pay.
Private A/B	\$795 total for 1-4 guests	Add \$195 per extra guest, max eight. Later test \$995 for 1-4 only with demonstrated demand; no transport/coffee included.
Corporate A/B	\$1,195 total for up to six	Separate proposal with a defined specialist brief and extra preparation; quote any added guests/scope. Requires real expertise and buyer validation.
Optional guided return	\$40/person retained	Do not raise it on assumptions alone. Explain the escort and Muni teaching; guest fare remains separate.

These are recommended test bands, not estimated market-clearing prices. The current website lists A/B at \$195; the \$149 pilot remains unactivated, and C/private/corporate offers are not bookable. A/B can ultimately have different prices, but the first pilot still concentrates on B.

HOW FAR TO GO ON THE PRESENT SHARED OFFER

\$225 is the next experimental upper price. Do not budget around \$249-\$295 for the current shared walk/Muni experience. A higher tier needs a specific audience and additional demonstrated value, with every extra cost included. No office access, celebrity meeting or affiliation is promised.

Protect the premium through a rehearsed route, original sourced interpretation, credible answers, useful Muni teaching and a clear onward plan. Coffee and fares stay guest-paid. Any new feature must fit the advertised time and its preparation budget before being marketed.



47

Run the higher-price business cases

Six weeks / 12 completed dates / 48 guests / no returns / all owner time at \$40

Ticket	Sales	Operating surplus	Op. margin	After setup	6-week ROI*
\$149	\$7,152.00	\$2,771.23	38.7%	\$781.23	26.0%
\$195	\$9,360.00	\$4,848.96	51.8%	\$2,858.96	95.3%
\$225	\$10,800.00	\$6,204.00	57.4%	\$4,214.00	140.5%
\$249	\$11,952.00	\$7,288.03	61.0%	\$5,298.03	176.6%
\$275	\$13,200.00	\$8,462.40	64.1%	\$6,472.40	215.7%
\$295	\$14,160.00	\$9,365.76	66.1%	\$7,375.76	245.9%

*Residual after startup cash and setup labor divided by the \$3,000 starting-cash target. Not annualized, not a cash-distribution promise, and not a forecast. Holding attendance constant illustrates arithmetic, not demand. The \$249-\$295 rows are stress cases, not recommended launch prices.

All costs are still counted

Operating base: \$3,848.40 = 72 owner hours x \$40 (\$2,880), 12 guide fares (\$68.40), and \$900 insurance/marketing/web/admin. Per guest: \$2 materials, 2.9% + \$0.30 processing and a 3% service-recovery reserve. Then deduct \$1,350 setup cash and \$640 setup owner labor. Do not deduct the retained \$750 cash cushion again.

\$225 ticket / same 12 dates	48 guests	60 guests	72 guests
Operating surplus	\$6,204.00	\$8,717.10	\$11,230.20
Operating margin	57.4%	64.6%	69.3%
After setup and setup labor	\$4,214.00	\$6,727.10	\$9,240.20

Actual insurance, permits, customer acquisition, international cards, refunds and hours can differ. Startup quotes and actual paid-demand data are still missing. Figures exclude income taxes, financing, earlier development costs and unmodeled employee expenses. Preserve the SF wage floor of \$19.61 and budget full employee costs if hiring.



48

Price rises can reduce total profit

Illustrative demand losses / keep all 12 offered dates and their budgeted costs

Ticket	Paid guests	Sales	Operating surplus	After setup
\$195	48	\$9,360.00	\$4,848.96	\$2,858.96
\$225	42	\$9,450.00	\$4,947.45	\$2,957.45
\$225	40	\$9,000.00	\$4,528.60	\$2,538.60
\$249	36	\$8,964.00	\$4,503.92	\$2,513.92
\$275	32	\$8,800.00	\$4,358.80	\$2,368.80
\$295	28	\$8,260.00	\$3,859.86	\$1,869.86

Attendance values above are invented downside scenarios, not fitted demand forecasts. Fewer than 48 guests cannot support all 12 dates at the four-guest minimum: some dates must be canceled or combined with guest consent. Costs remain fully reserved here; actual savings or refund losses require a separate reconciliation.

THE \$225 THRESHOLD

Versus 48 guests at \$195, at least **42 guests at \$225** preserve modeled total contribution. At 40 guests, the higher price earns about **\$320 less**. With unchanged costs, \$225 must retain about **86.5%** of \$195 attendance.

Distribution fees can overturn a price increase

At \$225 and 48 guests, adding a hypothetical 20% sales commission to every booking reduces operating surplus from \$6,204.00 to **\$4,044.00**, and after-setup result to **\$2,054.00**. This retains existing card and marketing costs; real contracts can differ. Higher ticket prices do not compensate automatically for a more expensive channel.

Compare contribution per offered date and per qualified inquiry, not ticket price or margin alone. Record gross sales, channel deductions, failed dates, actual guide/admin hours and refund losses. When comparing offers, hold audience, lead time, day of week, scope and acquisition source as similar as practical.



Model private revenue separately

Illustrative direct-booking cases / 12 reserved dates / not added on top of shared tours

Party quote / guests	Hours per booking	6-week sales	Operating surplus	After setup	Bookings to recover all*
\$795 / 4	5.5	\$9,540.00	\$4,549.14	\$2,559.14	9
\$995 / 4	5.5	\$11,940.00	\$6,807.54	\$4,817.54	7
\$1195 / 6	7.5	\$14,340.00	\$8,057.94	\$6,067.94	7

*Whole bookings to cover the six-week committed budget plus \$1,990 setup. The \$995 row is a later price sensitivity; \$1,195 assumes a six-person corporate brief. All rows assume a buyer for each of 12 reserved dates; no such demand has been recorded.

Cost the additional work

Private: 3.5 guest hours plus two hours total preparation/customization/closeout = **5.5 hours per booking**. Corporate: allow four hours around the guest experience = **7.5 hours**. Both retain three general admin/sales hours weekly, \$900 six-week overhead, a \$5.70 guide fare/date, \$2 materials/guest, one domestic-card transaction per party and a 3% reserve.

At \$795 for four, 12 bookings produce **\$2,559.14 after setup**. Six bookings, while all 12 dates' costs stay committed, produce **-\$1,879.63** after setup. The price is attractive only if the bookings arrive and the extra work fits the allowance. Quotes may require more insurance, permits, staffing or acquisition spend.

Protect the schedule and compare the opportunity cost

A \$795 private party of four generates about **\$514.10** after modeled variable costs, 5.5 hours of guide work and guide fare, before shared overhead. Six \$195 public seats generate about **\$901.47** on the same basis with 4.5 guide hours. A private sale can earn less than a well-filled shared departure. Reserve separate dates or compare expected contribution before replacing one.

These are alternative schedules, not revenues to stack on one owner's existing date. The initial \$3,000 cash allowance and \$1,990 setup deduction are carried over only as assumptions; confirm incremental requirements for private/corporate work. Extra guest pricing is a proposed rate card, not market evidence.



50

Record the ceiling test and its assumptions

Supplement to A01-A80 / all entries below are proposals or estimates

ID	Assumption / review requirement
P01	Shared-tour price band. \$149-\$195 is the working band; \$225 is a controlled test ceiling, not measured willingness to pay. Compare paid conversion and contribution per offered date; before any increase.
P02	Higher shared prices. \$249/\$275/\$295 are sensitivity cases, not recommendations for the existing offer. Require a justified product/segment and paid demand; no automatic release.
P03	Branch distinction. A: first test \$149-\$175, later \$195; B: target \$195, test \$225; C: provisional \$195, later test \$225. A/C need separate route readiness and price evidence; no new active fares.
P04	Private A/B proposal. \$795 for 1-4; add \$195 for each additional guest, maximum eight. \$995 for 1-4 is a later stress/test case. Test actual private inquiries and paid bookings; measure displaced shared contribution.
P05	Corporate proposal. \$1,195 for up to six, with a defined specialist brief; extra guests individually quoted. Confirm guide expertise, scope and buyer budget; not a promised corporate sale.
P06	Private operating hours. 5.5 owner hours/private booking; 7.5 for corporate, including 3.5 guest hours. \$40/hour. Time customization, sales, guiding and follow-up; add overruns and employee costs.
P07	Private six-week model. 12 reserved dates; 3 admin hours/week; \$900 overhead; \$5.70 guide fare/date; \$2 materials/guest. One payment per party; 2.9% + \$0.30 plus 3% reserve; replace with actual fees and quotes.
P08	Demand and added channel cost. Attendance drops are illustrative, not estimated elasticity. Added 20% commission is a stress assumption. Record all dates, price, customer source, losses and hours; compare like-for-like channels.

Decision sequence: keep the six-week \$149 pilot baseline, then test \$195 as specified on page 43. If the \$195 block passes, use four comparable dates at \$225; keep the four-person minimum. When the \$195 block serves 24 guests, at least 21 at \$225 preserve contribution under equal costs. Also require the existing timing/margin gates and 80% positive value from at least 15 responses.

September 15 market-ceiling review: retain \$195 website price and closed sales; add \$225 as a bounded test, higher-price downside cases and conditional private proposals. No attendance, quote acceptance or price ceiling is validated. The owner/operator records the actuals and a go/revise/stop decision after each test block.



Operating and market sources

Clickable primary references / source context below

- [01]** SFMTA: fares and day pass
- [02]** SFMTA: how to ride Muni
- [03]** SFMTA: MuniMobile transition
- [04]** SFMTA: T Third Street
- [05]** SFMTA: 30 Stockton
- [06]** SFMTA: F Market & Wharves
- [07]** SFMTA: N Judah
- [08]** SFMTA: 7 Haight-Noriega / connections
- [09]** SFMTA: 22 Fillmore
- [10]** NPS: Ocean Beach weather and visitor guidance
- [11]** NPS: guided-service authorizations and fees
- [12]** Gardens of Golden Gate Park: tickets
- [13]** RH: San Francisco restaurant
- [14]** Outerlands: address, hours and group policy
- [15]** Giants: official game schedule
- [16]** Warriors: official game schedule
- [17]** Valkyries: official game schedule
- [18]** SF City Guides: format and donations
- [19]** NPS: Alcatraz ticket prices
- [20]** Local Tastes of the City: tours and prices

Food/e-bike and Santa Fe prices were rechecked September 15, 2026. City Guides/Alcatraz retain the September 14 benchmark context. SF minimum wage and Stripe domestic/international rates were rechecked September 15. Route details and teaching draw on the September 8-14 guide materials. Ocean Beach, NPS guided-service fees and Outerlands policies were rechecked September 14. Schedules, frontages, fares, admission prices and access must be checked for the actual departure.



Commercial and financial sources

Clickable primary references / source context below

- [\[21\] SF Native Tours: advertised offers](#)
- [\[22\] Dandyhorse: electric bike tours](#)
- [\[23\] Bay City Bike: Streets of San Francisco](#)
- [\[24\] Edible Excursions: North Berkeley tour](#)
- [\[25\] Extranomical: private Silicon Valley tour](#)
- [\[26\] Heritage Inspirations: Santa Fe e-bike tour](#)
- [\[27\] SF: minimum wage effective July 1, 2026](#)
- [\[28\] Stripe: standard processing fees](#)
- [\[29\] Stripe: Payment Links](#)
- [\[30\] Stripe: payout timing](#)
- [\[31\] SF Police Code: guide permits and licensing](#)
- [\[32\] SF Treasurer: business registration](#)
- [\[33\] SF Treasurer: First Year Free eligibility](#)
- [\[34\] California DOJ: advertised prices and hidden fees](#)
- [\[35\] CDTFA: destination-management services](#)
- [\[36\] Port: sign guidelines](#)
- [\[37\] California DIR: overtime](#)
- [\[38\] Y Combinator: San Francisco campus](#)
- [\[39\] Apple: January 2007 iPhone introduction](#)
- [\[40\] FBI: Alcatraz escape decoy heads](#)

Financial inputs consolidate the earlier materials with the September 15 pricing reassessment. \$149 replaces the \$100 pilot recommendation in this PDF and assumptions register; supporting older files retain their dated scenarios. They are estimates, not supplier quotes, sales results, tax advice or an employee payroll calculation. The pilot supersedes the earlier four-week test proposal; the larger monthly model remains a distinct scenario.

Current operator documents: GitHub business materials. Review website: AI SF Tour preview (owner sign-in required).



53

Wharf and private-market sources

Clickable primary references / source context below

- [41] Painted Ladies: city tour and Wharf pickup
- [42] Dylan: four-hour city and Muir Woods tour
- [43] Dylan: tour range and Alcatraz bundle starting price
- [44] Secret Food Tours: San Francisco prices and format
- [45] San Francisco Tour Co: private bespoke van tour
- [46] SF Native: private-tour starting price
- [47] SF Native: catalog with differing private starting price
- [48] Context: San Francisco tours currently unavailable

Additional market research checked September 15, 2026. Prices are published asking prices, not verified date-specific checkout totals or evidence of sales volume. Starting-price variation, inconsistent SF Native pages and unavailable Context tours are recorded rather than silently resolved.

The branch bands, private quotes and demand-loss scenarios are management proposals. They do not establish a market ceiling. See P01-P08 on page 50 and in the editable register for assumptions and review requirements. All additional sales/customization hours and displaced shared-tour capacity must be counted.